

wildtag.ai

Volunteer instructions for validating camera trap images

Thank you for helping validate camera trap images! This document walks you through everything, step by step. It should take a few minutes to get started, and you do not need any technical experience or software installed beforehand.

What's in your zip file

When you unzip the file you were sent, you will see:

- **Run wildtag.bat** — double-click this one to start (see below).
- **wildtag.py** — the app itself. You do not need to open this directly.
- **validate_env** — a private, self-contained copy of everything wildtag needs to run. You do not need to install Python or anything else.
- A folder named after the species you're validating, containing the images.

You do not need internet access, admin rights, or any software installed to run this. Everything needed is already included in the folder.

Step 1 — Unzip the file

1. Right-click the zip file you were sent.
2. Choose "Extract All..." and pick a location, e.g. your Desktop.
3. Open the resulting folder.

Step 2 — Start wildtag

1. Double-click **Run wildtag.bat**.
2. A black window will briefly appear. This is normal, leave it be.
3. A few seconds later, the wildtag window will open.

Windows may show a blue "Windows protected your PC" warning the first time, since this app isn't digitally signed. Click "More info", then "Run anyway". This is expected and safe, it happens because the app is new, not because anything is wrong.

Step 3 — Validate the images

1. Click the **Validate** tab on the left.
2. Click **Browse** next to "Validation folder" and select the species folder inside your unzipped folder.
3. A gallery of images will appear, each already labelled with the species wildtag detected.
4. For each image: if the label looks correct, do nothing and move on. If it looks wrong, click the image and choose the correct species from the list, then apply the correction.
5. If the correct species is not in the list, use the **"Not listed? Add a label"** box to add it. Your new label is then available for the rest of your images.

6. If you genuinely cannot identify the animal, choose "**unidentifiable**" from the top of the list rather than guessing.
7. Other detections in the same photo, if any, are shown as a thinner amber box. You don't need to do anything with those, they're just there for context.
8. When you've been through a batch of images, click **Mark batch complete** and confirm.
9. Repeat until every batch is done, then close wildtag.

Step 4 — Send your results back

1. Find the species-named folder (not the whole unzipped folder).
2. Right-click it and choose "Send to" → "Compressed (zipped) folder".
3. Send the resulting zip back to the project lead.

A few important notes

- You only need to flag images where the label is wrong, correct ones need no action.
- If you genuinely can't identify what's in an image, choose "unidentifiable" rather than guessing.
- Please don't rename, move, or delete any image files.
- Please don't edit validation.csv directly in Excel or any other program.

Thank you again for your help with this project.

Questions? Contact css6@st-andrews.ac.uk